Question 30

GH-300: Neighboring Tabs Technique

How does GitHub Copilot select context from open editor tabs in your IDE (Neighboring Tabs algorithm)?

A. It reads every file on your local hard drive sequentially.

✔ **B. It analyzes recently opened or active tabs and calculates semantic relevance to the current cursor file.**

C. It only evaluates files modified within the last 5 minutes.

D. It strictly reads files that share the exact same extension name.

Correct Answer: B

Copilot's extension uses a **neighboring tabs heuristic**. It inspects open tabs in the IDE workspace, scoring files based on semantic similarity, recent usage, and matching type definitions to assemble a compact context prompt.

Option Breakdown

- **A. Reads every file on hard drive:** Incorrect. Full drive indexing is inefficient and exceeds prompt context limits.
- **B. Analyzes open tabs for semantic relevance:** Correct. Calculates relevance weights based on open tab content matching the active cursor focus.
- **C. Only evaluates files modified in 5 mins:** Incorrect. Modification timestamps do not strictly limit context tab selection.
- **D. Strictly same file extension:** Incorrect. Copilot pulls context across mixed file types (e.g., matching a `.ts` file with a `.html` or `.css` tab).

💡 **GH-300 Exam Tip**
Opening related files (such as interface contracts or data models) in adjacent IDE tabs helps Copilot tailor its completions to your exact data types and API methods.